4th
TOP RANKING
UNIVERSITY

SANDIP
UNIVERSITY
UGC Recognised
Under Section 2(f) & 12(B) of UGC



Staff Grievance Redressal Policy

CAMPUS
Mahiravani, Trimbak Road,
Nashik, Maharashtra,422213

Date: 12/8/2018

GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL COMMITTEE FOR STAFF

1. Preamble

Sandip University, in compliance with the UGC (Grievance Redressal) Regulations, 2018, recognizes the importance of a transparent, fair, and equitable process for addressing grievances from its staff members. The establishment of a Grievance Redressal Committee (GRC) ensures that the voices of all employees—whether academic or non-academic—are heard and that their grievances are promptly addressed.

The primary aim of the GRC is to facilitate a just and supportive work environment, where staff can focus on their professional responsibilities without fear of bias, discrimination, or unfair treatment. By creating an effective grievance redressal mechanism, the University fosters a culture of respect, accountability, and integrity, ensuring the well-being and satisfaction of its workforce. The Committee will handle grievances related to service conditions, work environment, administrative decisions, and interpersonal conflicts that could affect staff morale and performance.

2. Objectives of the Grievance Redressal Committee

The Grievance Redressal Committee (GRC) has been constituted to meet the following objectives:

2.1. Platform for Grievances

To provide a structured and reliable platform for staff members to voice their grievances without fear of retaliation or victimization. It ensures that grievances are registered, investigated, and resolved in a systematic and impartial manner.

2.2. Timely Resolution

To ensure that grievances are addressed in a time-bound manner. The Committee will ensure that grievances are acknowledged promptly and resolved within a predefined period, fostering trust in the redressal system.

2.3. Fairness and Impartiality

To establish procedures that are just and equitable for all parties involved. The Committee aims to avoid any favoritism or bias in the redressal process, upholding the principles of natural justice.

2.4. Policy Recommendations

To recommend any necessary changes or improvements to University policies and guidelines based on the nature of grievances received. This may involve revisiting

SANDIP UNIVERSITY MAHIRAVANI NASHIK

existing policies or suggesting the creation of new policies that promote a more inclusive and supportive work environment.

2.5. Promote Transparency and Accountability
To ensure transparency in all grievance-related matters. The Committee will provide regular updates on the status of complaints and the actions taken, thus ensuring accountability within the system.

3. Powers and Responsibilities of the Committee

3.1. Preventive Measures:

- Create a Safe Environment:
The Committee will ensure that a professional and respectful work environment is maintained across all departments. Efforts will be made to prevent any form of discrimination, harassment, or unfair treatment.

- Promote Equality and Justice:
The Committee will work to cultivate a work culture where all staff members, irrespective of their position, gender, or background, are treated with respect and fairness. Educational programs on diversity, equity, and inclusion will be conducted to reinforce these values.

- Publicize Policy:
All grievance redressal procedures, committee roles, and contact details of committee members will be clearly communicated to staff through the University website, internal communications, and notice boards to ensure easy access to grievance resolution mechanisms.

- Organize Sensitization Programs:
The Committee will plan and execute regular workshops, seminars, and training sessions to raise awareness among staff members about the grievance redressal system, as well as related policies such as anti-harassment, anti-discrimination, and ethics in the workplace.

3.2. Remedial Measures:

- Acknowledge and Investigate Complaints:
Upon receiving a complaint, the Committee will acknowledge its receipt within two working days and initiate an investigation. The investigation will be conducted in a confidential manner, ensuring that the complainant and the respondent are given opportunities to present their sides.

SANDIP UNIVERSITY MAH. NASHIK

• Provide Support to Complainant:
Depending on the nature of the grievance, the Committee will ensure that the complainant is supported emotionally, legally, or medically. This could include offering counseling services, facilitating legal advice, or coordinating with health professionals.

• Recommend Disciplinary Action:
Based on the investigation, the Committee will recommend appropriate disciplinary actions to the relevant authorities. This could range from verbal warnings to suspension, depending on the severity of the grievance.

• Monitor Follow-Up Actions:
After a decision is made, the Committee will oversee the implementation of follow-up actions to ensure that the grievance has been fully addressed and that there is no recurrence.

3.3. Disciplinary Recommendations:

Based on the findings, the Committee may recommend the following actions to the concerned authority:

- Verbal or written warnings.
- Mandatory counseling sessions for involved parties.
- Reassigning of duties or responsibilities.
- Further disciplinary action based on the severity of the grievance.

4. Procedures for Registering Grievances

4.1. Submission of Complaints:
Any staff member who has a grievance related to service conditions, interpersonal relations, harassment, or any other work-related issue may submit a formal written complaint to the Registrar, Dean, or the Convener of the Grievance Redressal Committee. Complaints can be submitted via email or in person, and they must contain all relevant details regarding the issue.

4.2. Acknowledgment and Forwarding:
Upon receipt of the complaint, the designated recipient will acknowledge the complaint within two working days and forward it to the Grievance Redressal Committee for review.

4.3. Option for Representation:
If desired, the complainant may be accompanied by a colleague or a representative during any discussions or hearings with the Committee.

4.4. Confidentiality:

The Committee is bound to maintain complete confidentiality throughout the investigation process. The identity of the complainant and the accused will only be disclosed with their consent or as required by law. Confidentiality will be maintained even after the resolution, unless disclosure is necessary for the implementation of the recommendations.

4.5. Resolution Timeline:
The Committee will aim to resolve the grievance within 15 working days. In cases that require further investigation or external consultation, the timeline may be extended with the consent of the complainant.

4.6. Final Report:
Upon completion of the investigation, the Committee will submit a final report containing its findings and recommendations to the appropriate authority, such as the Vice-Chancellor or the Registrar, for action. The complainant will be informed in writing of the outcome.

5. Committee Meetings and Quorum

5.1. Frequency of Meetings:
The Grievance Redressal Committee will meet quarterly to review the status of grievances and assess the effectiveness of the existing grievance redressal mechanisms. In addition, the Committee will hold special meetings as soon as a grievance is received, within two working days of submission.

5.2. Quorum for Meetings:
A quorum of at least one-third of the total committee members is required for the meeting to proceed. This must include at least one member representing the category of the complainant and one external member (such as a legal or social work expert).

5.3. Documentation of Proceedings:
Minutes of all meetings will be recorded, and copies of the decisions will be communicated to all relevant parties, including the complainant, respondent, and higher authorities.

7. Additional Guidelines

7.1. Non-Retaliation Policy:
Filing a grievance will not affect the complainant's employment status, salary, promotion, or future opportunities within the University. Any attempts at retaliation against the complainant will be treated as a serious violation and may result in disciplinary action against the retaliator.

7.2. Conflicts of Interest:
Any member of the Committee who is directly or indirectly involved in the grievance must step.

SANDIP UNIVERSITY MAHARASHTRA NASHIK

4



SANDIP
UNIVERSITY
UGC Recognised
Under Section 2(f) & 12(B) of UGC
www.sandipuniversity.edu.in

CAMPUS
Mahiravani, Trimbak Road,
Nashik, Maharashtra, 422213
info@sandipuniversity.edu.in